Lab 1 – GradPace Descriptive Paper

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4/25/2026

Version 1

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1 Introduction

In 2025, around 48% of new college graduates reported feeling underqualified for entry-level positions in the field their major applies (Cengage Group, 2025). Career preparation during college is currently self-led, leaving many undergraduate students guessing and hoping that they're ready to join the workforce after graduation without any real guidance. Universities define academic degree requirements, however professional development exists across many separate departments, platforms, and resources, leaving students to figure everything out on their own. Our solution is GradPace. GradPace is a dynamic tool that provides real metrics and suggestions to guide a student towards their field of choice by analyzing a student's resumes, transcripts, and university coursework, then provides a dynamic roadmap towards their goal to minimize any confusion and ensure students are confident and prepared for their future.

GradPace's dynamic roadmap system aggregates academic records, internship experience, projects, and extracurricular activities into one data model, personalized for each member. This data model is compared with a state-of-the-art industry survey that GradPace updates frequently, which holds information from leading companies regarding what they expect from new hires in entry-level roles. The difference between the two data models is where a student needs to strengthen their skills, giving real, solid feedback that a student can use to prepare for their future. By making career readiness a measurable statistic, we transform confusing career navigation into a proactive, structured development process. This solution not only helps students gain the confidence they need to succeed post-graduation but also helps universities know which parts of their academic departments may be falling out of date and require a refresh to stay relevant with current market trends.

2 Product Description

- To be completed

2.1 Key Product Features and Capabilities

- To be completed

2.2 Major Components (Hardware/Software)

- To be completed

3 Identification of Case Study

- To be completed

4 Glossary

- **Dynamic:** Something characterized by constant change, activity, or energy.
- **Roadmap:** A high-level, visual strategic plan outlining the goals, milestones, and essential steps required to achieve a long-term objective.
- **Personalized:** Items, services, or experiences specifically designed, adapted, or marked to meet the individual requirements, tastes, or ownership of a particular person.

5 References

- Cengage Group. (2025). The Missing Link: Accountability in Career Readiness. Cengage Group. https://www.cengagegroup.com/edtech-research/employability-report/